



**Economic Impact
and Benefits
of Tourism, Recreation,
Trails, Conservation
and Healthy Living**

Economic Impact

Economic Benefits of Tourism

Economic Impact-Tourism

PA Economic Impact of Visitor Spending-2010

- **Total Visitor Spending \$31.1 billion**
 - Leisure Travelers..... \$26 billion
 - Business Travelers.....\$ 5 billion
- **Total Economic Impact..... \$32.9 billion**
- **Total Jobs Supported 433,000**
 - Total Direct Jobs283,000
- **State & Local Tax Revenues.. \$3.4 billion**

From DCED's VisitPA program

<http://cdn.visitpa.com/sites/visitpa.com/files/2009%20Economic%20Impact%20of%20Travel%20Report.pdf>

Economic Impact-Tourism

Laurel Highlands: Economic Impact of Visitor Spending-2010

- **Total Domestic Traveler Spending\$1.7 billion**
 - Transportation in PA..... 30%
 - Lodging..... 15%
 - Food & Beverage 23%
 - Recreation 15%
 - Shopping 16%
- **Total Economic Impact.....\$32.9 billion**
- **Total Jobs Supported 433,000**
 - Total Direct Jobs283,000
- **State & Local Tax Revenues \$3.4 billion**

<http://cdn.visitpa.com/sites/visitpa.com/files/2009%20Economic%20Impact%20of%20Travel%20Report.pdf>

Economic Impact-Tourism

Economic Impact of PA's Heritage Areas, 2008 study of visitors to 12 state heritage areas

- \$416.9 million in direct, indirect and induced sales
- \$300.9 million in direct sales
- \$156.4 million in payroll
- 6,030 jobs
- Breakdown:
 - 56% (\$168.3 M by visitors in motels, B&Bs, etc.
 - 29% (\$88.0 M by visitors camping or staying with friends or family
 - 15% (\$44.6 M) out of town day visitors

http://www.heritagepa.net/publication_files/summary-of-economic-impact-study.pdf

Economic Impact-Tourism

Economic Impact of Lincoln Highway State Heritage Area, 2008 study

- \$44.7 million in direct, indirect and induced sales.
- \$43.5 million in direct sales.
- \$15.2 million in payroll.
- 1,036 jobs.
- Breakdown of Visitors:
 - 40.9% non-local residents (26% out-of-state)
 - 30.9 % local residents
 - 14.9% stayed in hotels, motels, B&Bs, etc.
 - 13.3% camped/stayed with friends or family
 - 15% (\$44.6 M) out of town day visitors

http://www.heritagepa.net/publication_files/summary-of-economic-impact-study.pdf

Economic Impact-Tourism

Economic Impact of National Road State Heritage Area, 2008 study

- \$76.4 million in direct, indirect and induced sales.
- \$74.2 million in direct sales.
- \$26.0 million in personal income e.g. wages.
- 1,768 jobs.
- Breakdown of Visitors:
 - 22.3% corridor residents
 - 77.7% non-local (37.8% out-of-state, 2.6% foreign)
 - 42.6% stayed in hotels, motels, B&Bs, etc.
 - 18.6% camped
 - 29.3% stayed with friends or family

<http://www.nationalroadpa.org/>

Economic Impact

Economic Benefits of Outdoor Recreation

Economic Impact-Recreation

PA State Parks Visitors Impact

- 33.6 million visitors in 2010.
- Visitors spent \$738 million:
 - \$563.2 million by resident visitors.
 - \$167.2 million by out-of-state visitors.
 - \$7.9 million at marinas, whitewater/ski areas.
- Overall contribution to PA economy:
 - 10,551 jobs.
 - \$291.4 million in wage & salary income.
 - \$464.7 million in value-added effects.

<http://www.dcnr.state.pa.us/stateparks/economicimpact/index.aspx>

Economic Impact-Recreation

PA State Parks Visitor Impact

Comparison of spending and jobs by Region, all visitors (residents/out of state); Laurel Highlands is Region 2.

Region	Northcentral (Region 1)	Western (Region 2)	Southcentral (Region 3)	Eastern (Region 4)	Total (All Regions)
Total spending (\$000s)	\$60,786	\$290,202	\$140,175	\$247,083	\$738,245
Jobs (Total Effects)	865	4,198	2,017	3,396	10,476

<http://www.dcnr.state.pa.us/stateparks/economicimpact/index.aspx>

Economic Impact-Recreation

PA State Parks Visitor Impact

State Parks in the Laurel Highlands CLI

	Key-stone	Kooser	Laurel Hill	Laurel Mtn	Laurel Ridge	Laurel Sum.	Linn Run	Ohio-pyle	Total
Visitors spent	\$6.33	\$1.69	\$6.16	\$2.21	\$2.62	\$0.36	\$3.34	\$28.04	\$50.75
Generated sales of	\$6.80	\$1.85	\$6.51	\$2.31	\$2.34	\$0.37	\$3.65	\$32.81	\$56.63
Jobs created	85	23	82	30	36	5	45	415	721
Labor income	\$2.48	\$0.67	\$2.39	\$0.84	\$0.83	\$0.14	\$1.33	\$12.15	\$20.83
Value added	\$3.95	\$1.08	\$3.79	\$1.34	\$1.27	\$0.22	\$2.12	\$19.16	\$32.93

<http://www.dcnr.state.pa.us/stateparks/economicimpact/index.aspx>

Economic Impact-Recreation

DCNR Outdoor Traveler Study-1997

- 112.4 million person-trips
- 15.7 million person-trips for outdoor recreation
- \$4.03 billion spent on trips for outdoor recreation
- \$5.73 billion in direct + indirect economic activity
- \$1.51 billion in wage/salary earnings
- \$770.7 million in tax revenues
- More than 84,120 jobs

<http://www.dcnr.state.pa.us/recstudy/outdoorsurvey.pdf>

Economic Impact-Recreation

DCNR Outdoor Traveler Study-1997

PA Travel Direct & Indirect Impact

Region	Spending	Earnings	Employment	Taxes
Laurel Highlands	\$213.4 M	\$79.3 M	4,490 jobs	\$40.5 M
Pittsburgh Region	\$204.1 M	\$74.7 M	4,070 jobs	\$38.2 M
PA Total	\$4,026.3 M	\$2,510.9 M	84,120 jobs	\$770.7 M

Economic Impact-Recreation

Active Outdoor Recreation Economy, Outdoor Industry Foundation, 2006

In the Mid-Atlantic Region—PA, NY, NJ

	Bicycling	Fishing	Paddling	Snow-based	Trail-based	Wildlife Viewing
# of participants (millions)	8.16	3.5	3.36	2.16	6.65	9.58
% of population	26%	11%	11%	7%	22%	31%
Gear retail sales (millions)	\$677	\$509	\$356	\$461	\$401	\$1,120
Trip-related sales (millions)	\$3,097	\$1,119	\$1,591	\$3,047	\$3,792	\$623
Jobs supported	44,398	26,012	22,844	41,172	49,218	35,600
Taxes-Fed/state	\$555	\$238	\$321	\$579	\$692	\$217
Total Economic Contribution	\$4,757	\$3,073	\$2,453	\$4,421	\$5,285	\$3,303

<http://www.outdoorindustry.org/images/researchfiles/RecEconomypublic.pdf?26>

Economic Impact-Recreation

National Outdoor Recreation Economy, Outdoor Industry Foundation, 2006

Outdoor recreation:

- \$730 billion/year contributed to U.S. economy.
- 6.5 million jobs.
- \$88 billion/year in tax revenue.
- \$289 billion/year in retail sales and services.

Mid-Atlantic Region (PA, NY, NY):

- \$38.3 billion total contribution.
- 357,258 jobs generated.
- \$23 billion in trip-related sales.
- \$5.2 billion in gear sales.

<http://www.outdoorindustry.org/images/researchfiles/RecEconomypublic.pdf?26>

Economic Impact-Recreation

Active Outdoor Recreation Economy, Outdoor Industry Foundation, 2006

The number of Americans who participate in:

- Wildlife Viewing 66 million
- Bicycling 60 million
- Trails 56 million
- Camping 45 million
- Fishing 33 million
- Paddling 24 million
- Snow Sports 16 million
- Hunting 13 million

<http://www.outdoorindustry.org/images/researchfiles/RecEconomypublic.pdf?26>

Economic Impact-Recreation

Active Outdoor Recreation Economy, Outdoor Industry Foundation, 2006

- More Americans camp than play basketball.
- The number of Americans who bicycle is double the population of Canada.
- More Americans paddle (kayak, canoe, raft) than play soccer.
- The number of annual participants in snow-based recreation is more than double the combined annual attendance for NASCAR's two premier series.
- Active outdoor recreation employs 5 times more Americans than Wal-Mart, the world's largest private employer.

Economic Impact-Recreation

Economic Effects of River Recreation

1990 study of the impact of recreation at Upper Delaware Scenic & Recreational River (PA-NY), Delaware Water Gap National Recreation Area (PA-NJ), New River Gorge National River (WV).

	Visits	% non-local	Direct Total Output	Total Effects	Wages-Salaries	Direct Jobs	Total Jobs
Upper Delaware	232,600	83%	\$6.6 million	\$13.4 million	\$3.5 million	185	292
Delaware Water Gap	135,400	67%	\$3.5 million	\$6.9 million	\$1.9 million	104	156
New River Gorge	100,000	66%	\$1.2 million	\$2.6 million	\$0.8 million	33	60

<http://www.treesearch.fs.fed.us/pubs/20305>

Economic Impact-Recreation

Economic Value: Recreational Fishing and Boating, Upper Snake River Wyoming-Idaho

Study assessed the impact of the Snake River near Jackson Hole, Wyo.; cutthroat trout were target for half the anglers.

- 1,460 current jobs.
- 2,442 jobs if anglers would catch twice as many fish.
- \$46 million current income.
- \$77.5 million income if catch twice as many fish.
- Economic “value” (how much more were anglers willing to pay vs. what they actually did pay):
 - \$39.4 million.

<http://www.tu.org/atf/cf/%7B0D18ECB7-7347-445B-A38E-65B282BBBD8A%7D/Final%20Loomis%20%20HFF%20TU%20SR%20Full%20Report%205-02-05.pdf>

Economic Impact-Recreation

National Survey- Fishing, Hunting, Wildlife Watching

2006 survey, U.S. FWS and Census Bureau

	Fishing	Hunting	Wildlife Watching	Total
Participants	30.0 million	12.5 million	71.1 million	87.5 million*
Days of Activity	516.8 million	220 million	352.1 million	
Expend- itures	\$42.2 billion	\$22.9 billion	\$45.7 billion	\$122.3 billion

8.5 million both hunted and fished, nearly 20 million watched wildlife and hunted or fished.

http://wsfrprograms.fws.gov/Subpages/NationalSurvey/nat_survey2006_final.pdf

Economic Impact-Trails

Economic Benefits of Trails

Economic Impacts-Trails

Great Allegheny Passage

- 132 miles, Pittsburgh-Cumberland, MD; meets C&O Canal Towpath to Washington, DC
- 750,000 visits/year
- \$40.8 million per year actual spending in Trail Town businesses:
 - \$7.5 million in wages paid
 - 40% stayed overnight spending \$98/day
 - 67% bought soft goods averaging \$13/person/day



http://www.trailtowns.org/Data/Sites/1/07-294gapeconomicimpactstudy2008-2009_executivesummary.pdf

Economic Impact-Trails

Heritage Rail Trail-York PA

- 21 miles long
- 394,823 estimate users in 2007, 12.5% stayed overnight
- Average spent per person per trip: \$12.86
- Total estimated annual spending: \$4.0 Million

<http://www.yorkcountyparks.org/PDF/2007%20Rail%20Trail%20User%20Survey%20Report%20VERSION%204.1.pdf>

Economic Impact-Trails

Oil Heritage Region Trails

- 60 miles long
- 82,390 users, 17% stayed overnight
- Average spent per person per trip:
\$3.71/locals, \$32.93/non-locals
- Total annual spending: \$2.2 Million

www.avta-trails.org/AVTA-Study-2006.html

Economic Impact-Trails

Pine Creek Trail, PA Grand Canyon

- 63 miles long
- 125,000 users in 2006, 57% stayed overnight
- Average spent per person per trip: \$30.30
- Total estimated annual spending on goods and overnight accommodations: \$3 to \$5 Million.

<http://community.railstotrails.org/media/p/11.aspx>

Economic Impact-Trails

Schuylkill River Trail – Philadelphia-Pottsville

- 56 miles of 125 miles planned had been built when study was done (2009)
- 802,239 estimated users in 2007, overnight stays did not significantly impact economies (less than 3% overnight).
- Average spent per person per trip: \$9.07
- Total estimated annual spending:
 - \$3.6 million along the trail plus
 - \$3.7 million on bikes/equipment



<http://community.railstotrails.org/media/p/6865.aspx>

Economic Impact-Trails

Ghost Town Trail, PA

- 36 miles, Ebensburg-Black Lick
- 75,557 estimated users in 2009
 - 12% stayed overnight, spent \$78/night.
 - 72% bought 'soft goods', average spent \$13.62/per person/trip
- Total estimated annual spending:
 - \$743,427 on soft goods
 - \$675,157 on hard goods
 - \$947,512 on accommodations



http://www.railstotrails.org/resources/documents/wherewework/northeast/Ghost_Town_Trail_User_Survey_LR.pdf

Economic Impact-Trails

Perkiomen Trail, PA

- 19 miles long, Montgomery County, connects to Schuylkill River Trail
- 397,814 estimated users in 2008, 3% stayed overnight
- 47% of respondents bought 'soft goods,' average spent per person per trip: \$11.09.
- Total estimated annual spending:
 - \$2.1 to \$3.6 M on soft goods
 - \$2.8 to \$3.6 M on hard goods

<http://community.railstotrails.org/media/p/12.aspx>

Economic Impact-Trails

Comparison, PA Rail-Trails

Trail	Annual visits	% non-local	Average spent	Total soft-goods
Great Allegheny Passage	700,000	40%	\$40.00	\$40.8 million
Pine Creek, 2006	138,227	69%	\$30.30	\$3.6 million
Perkomen, 2008	397,814	4%	\$11.09	\$2.3 million
Schuylkill, 2009	NA	2%	\$8.86	NA
Heritage, 2007	394,823	27%	\$12.86	\$4.0 million
Oil Heritage Region, 2006	160,792	27%	\$4/\$33*	\$4.3 million
Ghost Town, 2009	75,557	12%	\$14/\$78*	\$1.7 million

* Two figures are local spending/non-local spending, rather than one overall average for spending.

Economic Impact-Trails

Comparison, Non-PA Rail-Trails

Trail	Annual visits	% non-local	Average spent	Total soft-goods
Torrey Brown, Md, 2005	800,000	4%	\$9.14	\$5.3 million
Virginia Creeper, 2004	130,172	53%	\$2 or \$19*	\$2.5 million
Washington/Old Dominion, 2004	1,707,353	5%	\$4.11	\$7.0 million

* Two figures are local spending/non-local spending, not One overall average spending. Most of this is available at http://www.railstotrails.org/resources/documents/resource_docs/Comparison_of_Trail_Users_Surveys_FINAL.pdf

Economic Impact-Trails

Sea to Sky Mountain-bike Trails, British Columbia, 2006

	North Shore, Squamish, Whistler	Whistler Bike Park	Crankworx
Initial expenditures	\$10.3 million	\$16.2 million	\$12.0 million
Wages/salaries	\$6.3 million	\$12.8 million	\$9.2 million
Jobs	195	381	268
Industry Output	\$20.4 million	\$39.1 million	\$28.5 million
Taxes	\$4.6 million	\$8.1 million	\$6.4 million

Economic Impact-Trails

Mountain-biking, Moab, Utah, 1996

- \$8.4 to \$8.8 million Annual Impact
- 158,681 estimated users
- \$197 to \$205 average spending per person per trip.

Economic Impact-Conservation

Economic Benefits of Conservation

Economic Impact-Conservation

Allegheny National Forest Wilderness: Economic Benefits for PA, 2007

Friends of Allegheny Wilderness and the Wilderness Society advocating for 54,460 acres of new wilderness argued:

- **Value of eastern wilderness to visitors is \$44/acre plus visitors spend \$44/acre per year in nearby communities.**
- **Existing wilderness in ANF received 36,815 visits (2002).**
- **2.8 to 5 million state residents visit wilderness yearly.**
- **Property values are higher near wilderness; near Green Mountain NF in Vermont, land values are 18.7% higher.**

<http://wilderness.org/files/Economics-Wilderness-Allegheny.pdf>

Economic Impact-Conservation

Economic Benefits of Wilderness, Green Equals More Green, 2010

Wilderness Society describes 5 distinct benefits:

- **Direct spending by visitors-10,000 wilderness acres brings 11,000 visitor days creating 18 jobs.**
- **Attracts industry and creative workforce.**
- **Increases property values.**
- **Provides “ecosystem services” – clean water, less erosion and flooding, sequestered carbon....**
- **Provides “value” to people who never visit to want others now and in the future to enjoy it.**

<http://wilderness.org/content/green-equals-more-green-economic-benefits-wilderness>

Economic Impact-Conservation

Cleaning Up Abandoned Mine Drainage in the West Branch Susquehanna Watershed

- \$4 million in increase land values (\$2,500/acre) would occur in Clearfield County alone.
- \$22.3 million in sport-fishing revenue was lost in 2006.
- More drinking-water supply options would be available -- \$11 already spent to address drinking-water issues.
- Jobs would be created in the fishing and other services.
- Tax revenue would be generated from the wages and salaries, and from higher real-estate values.

Source: Trout Unlimited:

<http://www.wbsrc.com/economicbenefits.html>

Economic Impact-Conservation

Benefits of Acid Mine Drainage Remediation on the North Branch Potomac River

Lime dosers create fisheries and boating opportunities in Garrett and Allegany counties, MD. Benefits in North Branch:

- \$2.1 million/year spent by anglers and boaters.
- \$3.0 million in annual economic impact.
- 40 full-time jobs are supported.
- \$266,000/year in state and local tax revenue
- Anglers and boaters are willing to pay \$4.1 million more per year because they highly value this recreational experience.
- Dosers cost \$321,000/year; impact is 10 times more!

Source: Trout Unlimited:
(UPLOAD TO LH WEB SITE)

Economic Impact-Conservation

Economic Benefits of Smart Growth and Green Infrastructure

Economic Impact-Smart Growth

Economic Value of Protected Open Space, SE PA, GreenSpace Alliance, 2010

- Protected open space adds \$16.3 billion to value of the region's housing stock, generates \$240 million annually in property taxes.
- Saving of \$61 million from water filtering, \$37 billion in reduced flooding, \$17 million in reduced air pollution, carbon sequestration.
- \$1.3 billion/year in health-related cost savings -- avoided worker's comp/productivity losses plus \$795 million in lower medical costs.
- \$299 million in earnings from 6,900 jobs associated with protected green space.
- \$566 million in annual expenditures – 31% managing land, 36% in agriculture sales and 33% in tourist activity.

http://www.tpl.org/content_documents/EconBenefitsReport_7_2009.pdf

Study of 5 Southeastern PA counties for GreenSpace Alliance/Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission.

Economic Impact-Smart Growth

Economic Benefits of Parks and Open Space, Trust for Public Land, 2007

- Parks/open spaces increase property value. In Philadelphia, properties around parks and recreational had increased value of \$688.8 million and \$18.1 million more in property taxes.
- Urban parks generate tourism dollars. In Philadelphia, tourists traveled to the area primarily for parks and spent \$40.3 million.
- Ecosystem services include water and air. TLP estimated Philadelphia saves \$5.9 million annually in water treatment costs from water retention in city parks.
- Parks support walking, jogging, biking, etc that reduce the nation's healthcare bill by \$2 trillion annually.

http://www.tpl.org/content_documents/EconBenefitsReport_7_2009.pdf

Economic Impact-Smart Growth

How Much Value Does Philadelphia Receive from its Park and Rec System? Trust for Public Land, 2008

- City parks generate:
 - \$23 million in city revenue;
 - \$16 million in municipal cost savings;
 - \$729 million in wealth, including \$115 million spent by tourists;
 - \$1.1 billion in cost savings for citizens, 100 times the city's annual park costs.
- 255,000 Philadelphians are active enough in parks to improve their health. Residents saved \$69.4 million in health costs in 2007.
- City tax revenue from strictly park visitors in 2006: \$5,177,000.

http://www.tpl.org/content_documents/Philaparkvaluereport.pdf

Source: Trust for Public Land

Economic Impact-Smart Growth

Economic Benefits of Open Space, Recreation Facilities, Walkable Community Design, 2010

Review of over 60 studies found:

- Most open spaces increase property values but amount varies by size and type of space, proximity to residences. Example: home sale prices rose \$845-\$2,262 within 1,500 feet of park.
- Large parks do more for value but a series of small parks near more houses may produce more value.
- Visibility and access are important.
- Open space in urban areas provides greater economic benefit than in rural areas.
- Preserved farmland in rural and suburban areas has more impact on values than land that may be developed.

http://www.activelivingresearch.org/files/Synthesis_Shoup-Ewing_March2010.pdf

Economic Impact-Smart Growth

Smart Growth Lifts Sales Prices and Home Values, 2011

Market Acceptance of Smart Growth, an EPA report, found:

- Smart growth communities have a higher residential sale price and value per square foot than conventional suburban developments.
- In approximately 80% of comparisons, housing units in smart-growth developments sold for higher prices per square foot.

Study covered resale data in 18 smart growth and 18 conventional suburban developments from 1998 to 2004.

<http://newurbannetwork.com/article/smart-growth-lifts-sales-prices-home-values-14056>

Economic Impact-Green Infrastructure

Value of Green Infrastructure ***Guidebook of American Rivers***

- Existing research on green infrastructure benefit valuation
- Framework allows local communities to assess local benefits of green infrastructure.
- Methodology to measure and value improved air quality, energy savings, carbon sequestration, etc., benefits beyond stormwater control benefits.
- Helps communities make more educated investments in infrastructure by evaluating full range of benefits from sustainable approaches to water management.
- Done by Center for Neighborhood Technology and American Rivers.

<http://www.americanrivers.org/newsroom/press-releases/2011/new-guide-helps-1-21-2011.html>

Economic Impact-Health

Health Benefits and Medical Cost Savings from Exercise

Economic Impact -Health

Obesity-Related Statistics, Get Fit America Foundation

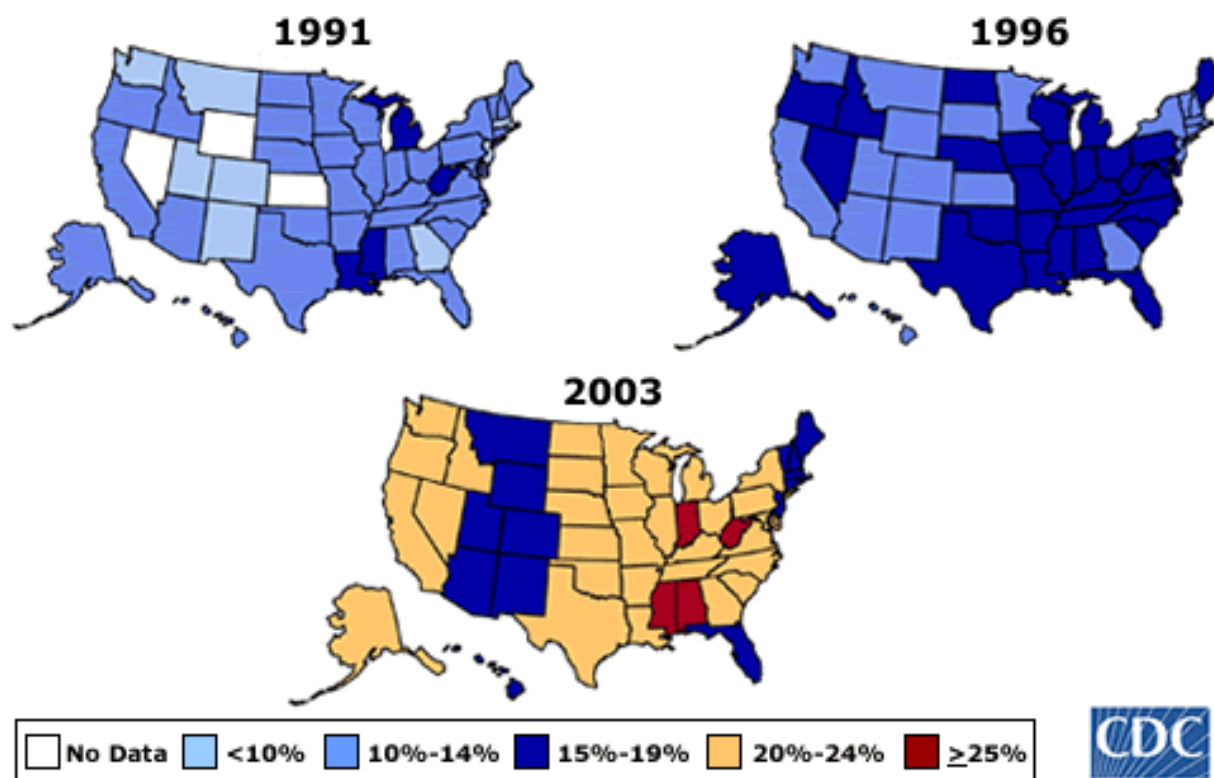
- Obesity is the #2 cause of preventable death in the United States.
- 60 million Americans, 20 years and older are obese.
- 9 million children and teens ages 6-19 are overweight.
- Being overweight or obese increases the risk of health conditions and diseases including:
 - Breast cancer, Coronary heart disease, Type II diabetes, Sleep apnea, Gallbladder disease, Osteoarthritis, Colon cancer, Hypertension and Stroke

<http://www.getamericafit.org/statistics-obesity-in-america.html>

Economic Impact -Health

Obesity Trends* Among US Adults CDC's Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System 1991-2003

(*BMI $\geq$ 30, or ~ 30 lbs overweight for 5'4" women)



<http://www.getamericafit.org/statistics-obesity-in-america.html>

Economic Impact -Health

Obesity-Related Statistics, Get Fit America Foundation

Obesity related disease costs include:

- Type II Diabetes (\$63.14 Billion)
- Osteoporosis (\$17.2 Billion)
- Hypertension (\$3.23 Billion)
- Heart Disease (\$6.99 Billion)
- Post-menopausal breast cancer (\$2.32 Billion)
- Colon Cancer (\$2.78 Billion)
- Endometrial Cancer (\$790 Million)

<http://www.getamericafit.org/statistics-obesity-in-america.html>

Economic Impact -Health

Obesity-Related Statistics, Get Fit America Foundation

Obesity-related expenses accounted for 9.1% of total U.S. medical costs in 1998, which in 2002 dollars was:

- \$92.6 billion.

Cost of Lost Productivity related to obesity:

- Workdays lost: \$39.3 Million
- Physician office visits: \$62.7 Million
- Restricted Activity days: \$29.9 Million
- Bed-Related days: \$89.5 Million

<http://www.getamericafit.org/statistics-obesity-in-america.html>

Economic Impact -Health

The Cost of Obesity, CNN, 2010

According to Centers for Disease Control and Prevention:

- **Direct and indirect cost of obesity using 2006 figures is:**
 - **“as high as \$147 billion annually.”**
- **Obese patients spent on average \$1,429 more for medical care than did people within a normal weight range -- 42% more than non-obese people.**
- **Medicare, Medicaid and private insurers increased spending due to obesity (including prescription-drug costs)**
 - **from 6.5 percent in 1998.**
 - **to 9.1 percent in 2006.**

<http://hpp.sagepub.com/content/9/4/426.full.pdf+html>

Economic Impact -Health

Cost-Benefit Analysis of Physical Activity Using Bike/Pedestrian Trails

- From a public health perspective, a cost-benefit analysis of using bike/pedestrian trails in Lincoln, Nebraska, to reduce health care costs associated with inactivity, was conducted.
- Per capita annual cost of using the trails was \$209.28 (\$59.28 construction and maintenance, \$150.00 of equipment and travel).
- Per capita annual direct medical benefit of using trails was \$564.41.
- Cost-benefit ratio was 2.94--every \$1 investment in trails led to nearly \$3 in direct medical benefit.

<http://hpp.sagepub.com/content/9/4/426.full.pdf+html>

Economic Impact-Health

For Good Health, Take a Hike!

Health magazine, March 22, 2009

Vorarberg Institute for Vascular Benefits and Treatment in 2004 had one group hike up a ski resort mountain, another hike down, for 2 months and found:

- Hiking uphill or downhill reduced HDL (“bad”) cholesterol.
- Only uphill hiking reduced triglyceride levels.
- Hiking downhill surprisingly was twice as effective as hiking uphill at removing blood sugars and improving glucose tolerance.

<http://www.miller-mccune.com/health/for-good-health-take-a-hike-3862/>

Economic Impact-Health

For Good Health, Take a Hike!

Health magazine, March 22, 2009

University of Essex in 2007 compared the benefits of hiking in the woods around a lake with those of walking in an indoor shopping center and found:

- 71% reported decreased levels of depression after hiking.
- 22% felt more depressed after walking indoors.
- 90% reported higher self-esteem after the nature hike.
- 44% reported lower self-esteem after indoor walking.
- 88% reported an improved mood after hiking.
- 44.5% reported feeling in a worse mood after indoor walking.

<http://www.miller-mccune.com/health/for-good-health-take-a-hike-3862/>